



New Volkswagen Tiguan

Volkswagen has finally introduced the Tiguan SUV in India. The SUV uses a host of electronics to make itself stand out. <http://dgit.in/TiguanInd>



Airlander 10 completes flight

World's largest aircraft, the Airlander 10 recently completes successful test flight getting closer to commercial use. <http://dgit.in/Airlander10i>

▶ LAB2MOON

TeamIndus held a Lab2Moon competition, a global challenge for students under 25 years of age to imagine, design and build a project that could accelerate human evolution into a sustainable multi planetary species. The teams that won are:

- **Team Space4Lab (Italy):** to test feasibility of making a Radiation Shield Using Bacteria.
- **Team Zoi (Kolkata, India):** to test if proper photosynthesis can take place on the moon by Extremophile Cyanobacteria.

▶ MOONSHOT WHEELS

With the goal of teaching rural students about space missions and their own lunar landing program, Team Indus, along with Agastya International Foundation, has started an initiative called Moonshot Wheels. Under this initiative, a bus will be travelling to 11 states where it will cover a distance of over 12500 km. The mission aims to interact with over 36,000 students in government schools and teach them about space exploration.

the two teams (ignoring Hakuto, which is going to piggyback on the same PSLV as TeamIndus) whose contracts are with agencies which have actually reached space with the specified craft already. The other one is Team SpaceIL, which has a launch contract with SpaceX aboard a Falcon 9 rocket.

Another crucial missing aspect – which had initially not allowed them to qualify for the Imaging part of the Terrestrial Milestone Prize – has been resolved with their agreement with the French National Space Agency CNES inked in January this year. Under this agreement, they will be carrying latest-generation CMOS micro-cameras developed in partnership with French firm 3DPlus – which allows CNES to test its cameras while TeamIndus gets the cameras it needs for the mission.

COUNTDOWN TO LAUNCH

Currently, Team Indus is in the final stages of its preparation for the

weeks will be spent on analysing the results before the final model is built and sent off to ISRO – after another round of testing!

ISRO will be performing their own set of tests on the craft to ensure its launch readiness before the actual launch aboard their own PSLV on December 28, 2017.

ALL ABOARD THE MOON EXPRESS

If you're thinking that Team Indus has no plans to continue after their maiden moonshot, you couldn't be further away from the truth. Team Indus has stated a desire to work on further moon missions with the objective of making it economical to travel to the moon and someday, colonise it. A crucial part of this would be increasing the payload possible without increasing costs as well as more robust spacecraft design.

Another long term goal that Team Indus has is prototyping a com-



What the Team Indus rover that rolls on to the moon could look like

THE FINAL STRETCH

Another condition that Google had put was that only teams with verified launch contracts by December 2016 would be allowed to continue in the competition. In November 2016, Team Indus signed a contract with Antrix corporation, the commercial arm of ISRO, confirming a launch date of December 28, 2017. The contract was verified later that month, making them the fourth team qualified to continue. A little known fact is that they are one of

launch. They have already started building a qualification model, which is something that will help them identify crucial errors or scope of improvement in the final stages of their mission. These tests, to be completed over the next two-and-a-half weeks or so, will involve a craft design that will be completely system integrated, only not containing the engine and some other components which will be tested separately. Post these tests, another two

munications satellite that can be mass-produced at very cheap rates in the future, so that organisations and even individuals can dream of reaching space with relatively lower costs involved. With the motivation of a prize to be won and putting India's name on the moon as the first country to have a privatised moon landing, Team Indus is definitely going places... places that have been generally considered out of reach for India. Well, not anymore! 